6. The international society must reorganize itself in order to eliminate the institutions that make war likely and nations must reform their political systems so that self-determination and democratic governance within states can help pacify relations among states.[3]

However, there were several manifestations of idealisms before and after the inter-War period. It can be said that there were “contending liberalisms” at work in world politics during that time and later. They can be classified as:

Liberal Internationalism: This strand of liberal thinking puts faith in human reason and believes that this reason could deliver freedom and justice in international relations. Their emphasis was on transformation of individual consciousness, abolishing war, setting up of a world government, promoting free trade and maintaining peace. Liberal internationalists talked about the ‘harmony of interests’ in international relations, which was vehemently criticized by E.H. Carr in his famous work *The Twenty Years’ Crisis* (1939). Jeremy Bentham (1748–1832) and Immanuel Kant (1724–1804) were the leading exponents of liberal internationalism.[4]

Idealism: Unlike the liberal internationalists, the idealists believed that peace and prosperity is not a natural condition but is one which must be constructed and for which the requirement is of “consciously devised machinery”. In other words, they talked about the establishment of an international institution to secure peace and, with this objective, they supported the moves for the establishment of the United Nations after the failure of the League of Nations. They were also the proponents of collective security, human rights, “New International Economic Order” peace and disarmament.

Liberal Institutionalism: David Mitrany (1966) and Ernst Haas (1968) were the earlier liberal institutionalists who believed that integration through international and regional institutions would help to solve common problems. Their work provided impetus for increased cooperation between the European states. The later liberal institutionalists such as Keohane and Nye emphasized the centrality of actors other than the states and focused on transnationalism and interdependence.